MIL-C-36165B
28 September 1976
SUPERSEDING
MIL-C-36165A(DSA-DM)
13 June 1972

MILITARY SPECIFICATION

COVER, MATTRESS, PLASTIC

This specification is approved for use by all Departments and Agencies of the Department of Defense.

1. SCOPE

1.1 This specification covers one type of plastic mattress cover, suitable for use in military medical facilities.

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 The following documents of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of the specification to the extent specified herein:

SPECIFICATIONS

FEDERAL

L-P-375	- Plastic Film, Flexible, Vinyl Chloride.
V-F-106	- Fastener, Slide, Interlocking.
PPP-B-636	- Boxes, Shipping, Fiberboard.
PPP-T-76	- Tape, Pressure-Sensitive Adhesive Paper, (for Carton Sealing).

STANDARDS

FEDERAL

FED-TEST-METHOD-STD-NO. 191	- Textile Test Methods.

Beneficial comments (recommendations, additions, deletions) and any pertinent data which may be of use in improving this document should be addressed to: Headquarters, Defense Personnel Support Center, ATTN: Directorate of Medical Materiel, Code ATT, 2800 South 20th Street, Philadelphia, PA 19101, by using the self-addressed Standardization Document Improvement Proposal (DD Form 1426) appearing at the end of this document or by letter.

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MILITARY

MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.
MIL-STD-129 - Marking for Shipment and Storage.

(Copies of specifications, standards, drawings, and publications required by contractors in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

2.2 Other publications. The following documents form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise indicated, the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposals shall apply.

AMERICAN SOCIETY FOR TESTING AND MATERIALS (ASTM)

ASTM-D1433 Flammability of Flexible Thin Plastic Sheeting.

ASTM-D882 Tensile Properties of Thin Plastic Sheeting.

(Copies of ASTM Standards may be obtained upon application to the American Society for Testing and Materials, 1916 Race Street, Philadelphia, PA 19103).

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 First article. When specified in the procurement document, the contractor shall furnish sample unit(s) for first article inspection and approval (see 4.1.2.1 and 6.2).

3.2 Material.

3.2.1 Sheeting.

3.2.1.1 Vinyl chloride. The sheeting shall be flexible, non-toxic vinyl chloride, .008 inch ± 10% thick, conforming to type I, class 1 of L-P-375.

3.2.1.2 Vinyl-nylon laminate. As an alternate, vinyl-nylon laminate may be used for sheeting. Laminate shall be made from nylon yarn, laminated on both sides with a plasticized vinyl-chloride polymer coating. Laminate shall be non-toxic and anti-bacterial; shall have a weight of 10.5 oz. per square yard, + 10%,-5%, and a tensile strength of not less than 50 pounds per linear inch in both the machine and fill directions.

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3.2.1.3 Resistance to boiling water. The sheeting shall not become brittle or sticky and the slide fastener shall remain operative, when tested as specified in 4.4.1.

3.2.1.4 Flammability. The sheeting shall be internally treated with flame retardant material, and shall not support combustion when tested as specified in 4.4.2. A translucent or milky white appearance resulting from the addition of the flame retardant material shall be acceptable.

3.2.1.5 Stain resistance. The sheeting shall show no effects, other than slight discoloration, to blood, saliva, oil, grease, alcohol, and perspiration, when tested as specified in 4.4.3.

3.2.2 Slide fastener. The slide fastener shall conform to V-F-106 for type I, style 6, size L, single slider, long tab pull, aluminum chain. The pull, slider, bridge stop, and bottom stop, shall be made from brass, plated with nickel, or nickel-silver. The white cotton tape for the slide fastener shall be impregnated with vinyl plastic on the pull side. If the alternate design and construction is used (3.3.1.1) the slide fastener shall conform to V-F-106 for type I, style 6, size LM, single slider, long tab pull, aluminum chain.

3.2.3 Eyelets. Eyelets shall be circular, metal-mesh, of non-corrosive metal, and shall be 1/2 ± 1/4 inch in outer diameter.

3.3 Design and construction. The design and construction of the mattress covers shall conform to figure 1, and this specification.

3.3.1 Cover construction. Mattress covers shall consist of a single panel of plastic sheeting, folded, and heat sealed along the sides and at the four corners, to conform to the configuration illustrated in figure 1. The mattress cover body shall be fabricated from plastic sheeting specified in 3.2.1. The raw edges of the cover sides and corners shall be joined by electronic heat seal. Reinforcement pieces shall be cut from the basic material and shall be neat sealed on the inside of the mattress cover as specified in 3.3.4. The reinforcements shall be attached in a manner which will not effect the opening and closing of the slide fastener. The slide fastener shall be not less than 55 inches long, centrally located at one end of the mattress cover, as shown in figure 1. A minimum of one eyelet shall be securely attached and centered in each side.

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3.3.1.1 Alternate design and construction. As an alternate to the design and construction specified in 3.3.1, the mattress cover shall be of a two-piece construction (body construction is one piece and panel for slide fastener is one piece) cut from the material specified in 3.2.1. The cover shall be electronically heat sealed and formed to provide a cover of a box type effect to conform to measurements specified in figure 1 with slide fastener closure at one end. The single body piece shall be folded end to end to form a double thickness and shall be of sufficient size to meet finished dimensions as specified in figure 1. The raw edges of the cover sides shall be seamed to within approximately 8 + 1/2 inches on each side from open end. The corners at the closed end shall be constructed and seamed to provide for the required boxing effect and height all around the cover. All seams shall be electronically heat sealed as specified in 3.3.2. The material in the 8 inch area on each side at the open end shall be taper cut or otherwise constructed for secure attachment of the slide fastener panel and to provide firm corners. The slide fastener panel shall be cut to fit across the open end and along both sides to overlap the opening in the main body piece sufficiently to make a heat seal as specified in 3.3.3 and to retain the box effect. Each end of the panel shall be taper cut or otherwise constructed for secure attachment to the cover The panel shall be center cut or slit lengthwise and the slide fastener electronically heat sealed in the panel. The slide fastener shall extend midway along the entire front of the boxed area and 6 ± 1/2 inches down each side. The slide fastener for the closure shall be not less than 47 inches long. The slide fastener panel shall be electronically heat sealed to the top, bottom, and along the sides of the cover. There shall be no raw edges on the outside of the cover or open seams remaining after the seaming operations. A tab, 1 inch wide by 2 inches long, shall be securely attached to each side wall to pull the cover over the mattress. A minimum of one eyelet shall be securely attached and centered in each side.

3.3.2 Seams.

3.3.2.1 Heat sealed seams. Vinyl-chloride plastic covers shall have heat sealed seams at least 5/32 inch in width. The heat sealed seams shall be neatly made, uniformly heat sealed, continuous and shall not weaken the basic material. All raw edges of heat sealed seams shall be located in the interior of the mattress cover, and shall not exceed 1/8 inch. When tested as specified in 4.4.4 the strength of the bond shall be not less than 65 percent of the tensile strength of the film.

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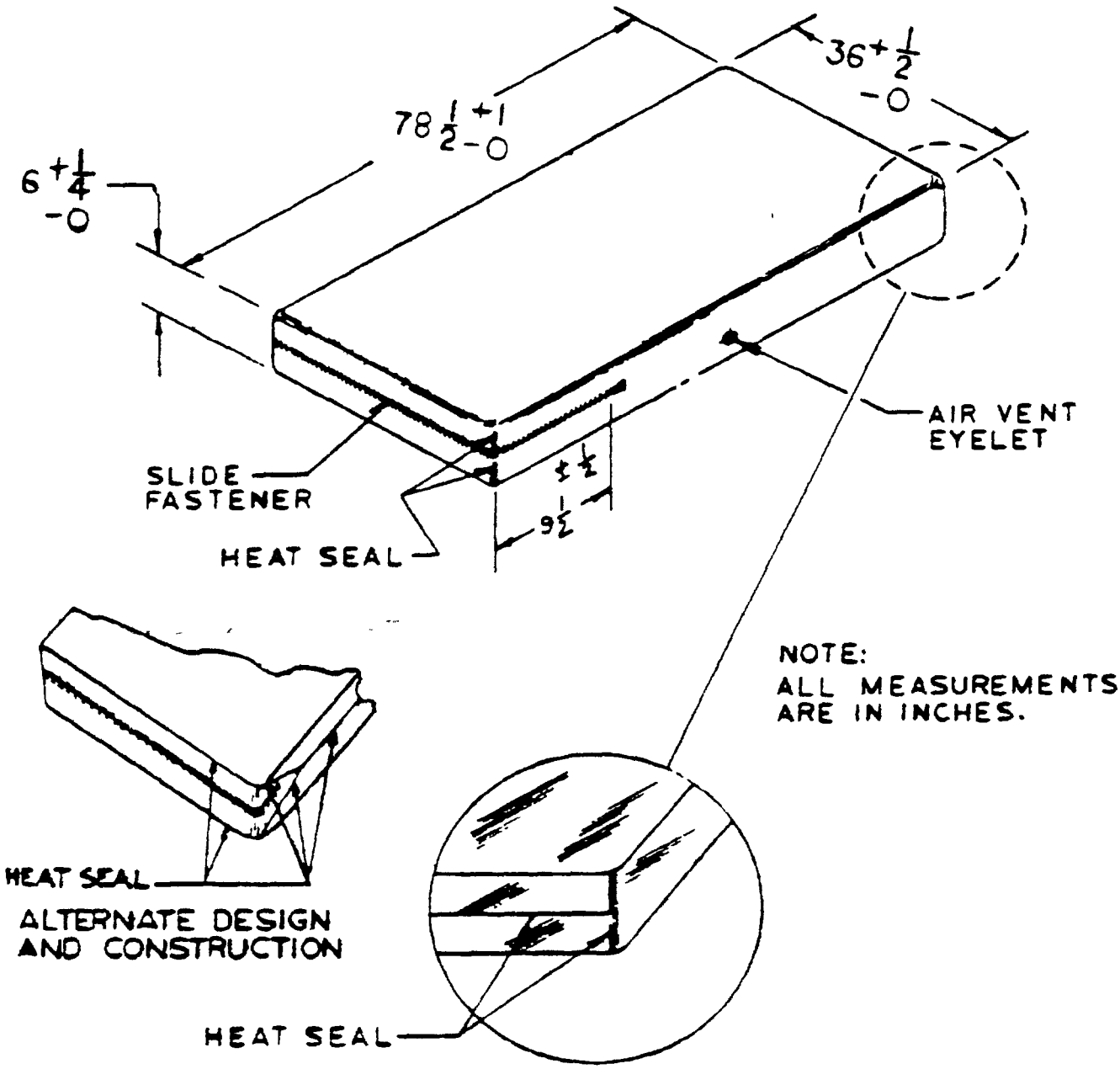


Figure 1. Cover, mattress, plastic

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3.3.2.2 Cemented seams. Vinyl-nylon covers shall be cemented or otherwise joined to provide moisture-proof seams. The seams shall be neatly made, uniformly sealed, and continuous; they shall not weaken the basic material. All raw edges of seams shall be located in the interior of the mattress cover and shall not exceed 1/8 inch. When tested as specified in 4.4.4, the strength of the bond shall be not less than 30 pounds per linear inch.

3.3.3 Slide fastener attachment. The slide fastener tape shall be attached on the inside of the vinyl chloride cover by means of electronic heat seal. The heat seals shall be 3/16 ± 1/32 inch in width, and shall extend beyond the slide fastener chain for a distance of not less than 1/2 inch at each end. The slide fastener shall be cemented or otherwise joined to vinyl-nylon covers to provide moisture-proof seams.

3.3.4 Reinforcement pieces. A strip of basic plastic sheeting, cut not less than 2 inches long and 1 inch wide, shall be heat sealed to the inside of the mattress cover at the juncture of each side seam and the cover opening. The front edge of the reinforcement piece shall be even with the juncture and the piece shall be centered on the heat sealed side seam. The length of the piece shall be parallel with the side seam.

3.4 Color. Color shall be white, clear, transparent, or partially transparent with white or near-white pigmentation.

3.5 Identification marking. Each mattress cover shall be permanently and legibly marked with the contract or purchase order number. Marking shall be applied by the heat method on the slide fastener tape.

3.6 Workmanship. Workmanship shall be first class throughout. The finished mattress cover shall be free from defects which detract from its appearance or may impair its serviceability.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract, the contractor may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

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4.1.1 Records. Records of examinations and tests performed by or for the contractor shall be maintained by the contractor and made available to the Government, upon the Government's request, at any time, or from time to time, during the performance of the contract and for a period of 3 years after delivery of the supplies to which such records relate.

4.1.2 Inspection. Inspection, as used in this specification, is defined as both examination (such as visual, and auditory, investigation without the use of special laboratory appliances or procedures) and testing (determination by technical means of physical and chemical properties) of the item.

4.1.2.1 Classification of inspection. The inspection requirements specified herein are classified as follows:

a. First article inspection.
b. Quality conformance inspection.

4.1.2.1.1 First article inspection. First article inspection shall be performed on cover when a first article sample is required (see 3.1). This inspection shall include examination of 4.3 and tests of 4.4.

4.1.2.1.2 Quality conformance inspection. Quality conformance inspection shall include the examination of 4.3 and tests of 4.4.

4.1.3 Certificates of quality. Certificates of quality, supplied by the manufacturer of the vinyl sheeting, may be furnished in lieu of actual performance of such testing by the contractor, provided lot identity nas been maintained and can be demonstrated to the Government. The Certificate shall include the name of the contractor, the contract number, the name of the manufacturer or supplier, the NSN, the Item Identification, the name of the component/material, the lot number, the lot size, the sample size, the date of testing, the test method, individual test results, and the specification requirements.

4.2 Sampling.

4.2.1 For examination. Sampling for examination shall be conducted in accordance with MIL-STD-105 and table I. The unit of product for examination shall be one cover.

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TABLE I. Sampling for examination.

	Inspection level	AQL (defects per hundred units)
For visual examination		
Major defects	I	2.5
Total (Major and minor combined)	I	6.5
For dimensional examination	S-3	6.5

4.2.2 For tests.

4.2.2.1 Cover. Sampling for tests of the mattress cover shall be conducted in accordance with MIL-STD-105 and table II. The acceptance level shall be zero for all sample sizes.

TABLE II. Sampling of mattress cover.

Characteristic	Requirement	Test Method	Inspection level
Resistance to boiling water	3.2.1.3	4.4.1	S-1
Bondability (breaking strength) of seams	3.3.2	4.4.4	S-1

4.2.2.2 Plastic sheeting. Samples of the material used in the fabrication of the mattress covers shall be selected for testing in accordance with table III. Two samples, randomly selected, shall be tested from each lot of plastic sheeting used in the manufacture of the cover. The dimensions of each test sample shall be as specified in the test method. Acceptance level shall be zero for all sample sizes.

TABLE III. Sampling of plastic sheeting.

Characteristic	Requirement	Test method
Thickness (vinyl-chloride)	3.2.1.1	4.4.5
Flammability	3.2.1.4	4.4.2
Stain Resistance		
to Blood	3.2.1.5	4.4.3.1
to Saliva	3.2.1.5	4.4.3.2
to Oil	3.2.1.5	4.4.3.3
to Grease	3.2.1.5	4.4.3.4
to Alcohol	3.2.1.5	4.4.3.5
Perspiration alkaline	3.2.1.5	4.4.3.6
Perspiration acid	3.2.1.5	4.4.3.6

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4.3 Examination. The mattress covers shall be examined to determine compliance with all requirements contained in this specification.

4.3.1 Classification of defects. Examination shall be conducted in accordance with table IV. Examination shall not be limited to the classified possible defects listed in table IV.

TABLE IV. Classification of defects.

Categories	Defects
	Quality and finish of plastic material
Major	
101	Material other than specified.
102	Bubble, sharp crease, wrinkle, blister, gouge or other imperfection.
103	Cut, tear, hole, break or crack.
Minor	
201	Material not uniformly colorless or not as approved sample (Note: Slight pigmentation will be permitted to neutralize any natural yellow tint or to acheive flame retardancy).
202	Finish other than smooth dull matte on both sides.
203	Objectionable odor (other than odor typical to Vinyl Chloride.
	Quality and finish of metal items
Major	
111	Material other than specified.
112	Neither nickel nor nickel-silver plated (except chain)
113	Any part fractured, split or broken
114	Sharp burr, splinter, sharp fin or sharp edge which may affect serviceability or injure user.
115	Corrosion or rust.
Minor	
211	Finish other than specified.
212	Mottled, tarnished, stained or scaly.
213	Plated surface peeling or blistered.

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TABLE IV. Classification of defects. - Continued

Categories	Defects
Major	Cover
121	Cover reinforcement piece missing.
122	Cover not constructed as specified.
Minor	
221	Cover reinforcement piece attached other than as specified, i.e., wrong side of sheeting, misplaced, not serving intended purpose, not heat sealed.
222	Heat seal raw edge or cut edge showing on outside of the cover.
223	Cover stained, not clean.
Major	Slide fastener
131	Slide fastener tape not heat sealed on inside of cover, inadequately heat sealed or reversed, i.e., pull is on inside of cover.
132	Slide fastener does not function properly or does not operate freely, smoothly, or positively, i.e., binds, catches or sticks at any point.
133	Slide fastener scoop which is improperly mated or does not mesh with its corresponding scoops when chain is in closed position.
134	Slider goes beyond stop.
135	Slider disengages from either row of scoops when chain is in closed position.
136	Slide fastener tape not impregnated with vinyl plastic on the pull side.
137	Slide pull becomes detached during operation.
138	Slide fastener tape not properly heat sealed to cover, i.e., tape separates from cover when slide fastener is operated vigorously.
Major	General
141	Component missing.
142	Open seam of heat seal.
143	Patch, splice or repair of plastic material (other than reinforcement pieces).

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TABLE IV. Classification of defects, - Continued

Categories	Defects
Minor	
241	Heat seal seam puckered or distorted in heat sealing.
242	Raw edge exceeds 1/8 inch.
243	Heat sealed seam not within specified width.
244	Heat seal seam misplaced, out of alignment, or not on a straight plane by more than 1/4 inch.
245	Foreign matter or material imbedded in the plastic sheeting.
Minor	Identification marking
251	Omitted, incomplete, illegible, incorrect, not proper size, misplaced.
252	Marking applied by other than heat method.

4.3.2 Dimensional examination. The mattress covers shall be examined for defects in dimensions. Any dimension not within the specified tolerances shall be classified as a defect.

4.3.3 Packaging inspection. The inspection of the unit, intermediate package, packing and marking for shipment and storage shall be in accordance with quality assurance provisions of the applicable container specification and the marking requirements of MIL-STD-129.

4.4 Tests. Tests shall be conducted, as necessary, to determine compliance with specification requirements.

4.4.1 Resistance to boiling water. The plastic sheeting and tape shall be placed in boiling water for 60 hours.

4.4.2 Flammability. The flammability of the material used in the fabrication of the mattress cover shall be tested as specified in ASTM D1433. "Flame retardant" shall be defined, for this specification, as the flame going out before it has reached the second thread (before it has travelled six inches).

4.4.3 Stain resistance.

4.4.3.1 Stain resistance to blood. Pour 5 milliliters (ml.) of blood (human, warm-blooded animal, or fowl) on a specimen of material 12 inches square. Spread the blood to a thin even layer. After drying, the dried blood shall be allowed to remain in contact with the plastic film for 24 hours. The specimen shall then be washed off with a cloth or sponge using soap and water. Observe for stains or discoloration.

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4.4.3.2 Stain resistance to saliva. Use the same method as specified in 4.4.3.1, except that human saliva shall be substituted for the blood.

4.4.3.3 Stain resistance to oil. Pour 5 ml of light mineral oil, U.S.P. or castor oil, U.S.P. on a specimen of material 12 inches square. Spread the oil to a thin layer. Allow the oil to remain in contact with the plastic film for 24 hours. Wash off with a cloth or sponge using soap and water. Observe for stains.

4.4.3.4 Stain resistance to grease. Use the same method as specified in 4.4.3.3, except that 5 grams of petrolatum shall be substituted for the oil.

4.4.3.5 Stain resistance to alcohol. Pour 5 ml. of rubbing isopropyl alcohol or 70 percent ethyl alcohol on a specimen of material 12 inches square. Spread to a thin layer. Permit the alcohol to evaporate at room temperature. Repeat the procedure every half hour for 4 hours. After 4 hours, wash with a cloth or sponge using soap and water. Observe for stains.

4.4.3.6 Stain resistance to perspiration. Pour 5 ml. of acid solution as specified in method 5682 of FED-TEST-METHOD-STD NO. 191 on a specimen of material 12 inches square. Spread the solution to a thin layer. After drying, allow the residue to remain in contact with the plastic film for 24 hours. Wash off with a cloth or sponge using soap and water. Observe for stains. Repeat the test using alkaline solution as specified in method 5682 of FED-TEST-METHOD-STD NO. 191. Wash off with a cloth or sponge using soap and water. Observe for stains.

4.4.4 Bond strength of seams. The bond strength of the seams be determined as specified in ASTM D 882, except that tests shall be made on each corner seam and one side seam. Specimens shall be prepared as follows:

(a) Four specimens, one from each corner, 1 inch wide by 7 inches long, shall be cut from each corner seal.

(b) Each side seam specimen from the cover shall be 1 inch wide and shall be cut from the side seam at any point on the seam. For breaking (bonding) strength of the bonded seam, the seam shall be at the center of the specimen and perpendicular to the centerline. The free ends of the specimen shall be gripped (one in each jaw) in the testing machine.

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4.4.5 Thickness. The thickness of the plastic shall be measured by a device accurate to .0001 inch.

5. PACKAGING

5.1 Packaging. Packaging shall be level A or C as specified (see 6.2).

5.1.1 Unit of issue. One cover, as specified, constitutes one unit of issue.

5.1.2 Level A.

5.1.2.1 Unit package. Each cover shall be folded in such a manner, that when packaged, the zipper and scoop shall be located at one end of the package with the exterior surfaces of the zipper and scoop adjacent to the inner faces of the container. Each folded cover shall be completely wrapped in a kraft paper envelope or bag of suitable size and design. Package shall be adequately secured to prevent accidental opening.

5.1.2.2 Intermediate package. Twelve unit packages shall be packaged in a box conforming to PPP-B-636, class domestic. Closure shall be as specified in the appendix of the box specification.

5.1.4 Level C. Units shall be packaged in standard commercial containers of the size and kind commonly used, which will afford the degree of protection required for shipment and use of the product for its intended purpose.

5.2 Packing. Packing shall be levels A, B or C as specified (see 6.2).

5.2.1 Level A. Two intermediate packages (24 units) shall be packed in an exterior container designed for a type 2 load and conforming to PPP-B-636, class weather-resistant. Closure, strapping and waterproofing shall be as specified in the appendix of the box specification.

5.2.2 Level B. Two intermediate packages (24 units) shall be packed in an exterior container designed for a type 2 load and conforming to PPP-B-636, class domestic. Closure shall be as specified in the appendix of the box specification.

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5.2.3 Level C. The subject commodity shall be packed in substantial commercial containers of the type, size, and kind commonly used for the purpose, so constructed as to insure acceptance and safe delivery by common or other carriers, at the lowest rate, to point of delivery called for in the contract or purchase order.

5.3 Marking.

5.3.1 Interior packages. Each unit package and each intermediate package shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129. Contract or purchase order number and name of contractor shall be shown.

5.3.2 Exterior container. Exterior container shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129.

6. NOTES

6.1 Intended use. The plastic mattress cover is used to protect mattresses from patients' excretions and secretions.

6.2 Ordering data. Purchasers should select the preferred options permitted herein and include the following information in procurement documents.

a. Title, number and date of this specification.
b. Selection of applicable levels of packaging and packing (see 5.1 and 5.2).
c. When a first article is required (see 3.1, 4.1.2.1 and 6.3).

6.3 First article. When a first article is required, it shall be tested and approved under the appropriate provisions of 7-104.55 of Armed Services Procurement Regulation. The contract or purchase order specifies the quantity, procedure for delivery and other specific instructions for inspection and approval of the first article.

6.4 This specification covers the following item(s) appearing in the Federal Supply Catalog:

National Stock Number	Item Identification
7210-00-082-5739	Cover, Mattress

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6.5 Changes from previous issue. Asterisks are not used in this revision to identify changes with respect to the previous issue, due to the extensiveness of the changes.

Custodians:
Army - MD
Navy - MS
Air Force - 03

Preparing activity:
DSA-DM

Project No. 7210-0217

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DOCUMENT IDENTIFIER AND TITLE
MIL-C-36165B COVER, MATTRESS, PLASTIC

NAME OF ORGANIZATION AND ADDRESS

CONTRACT NUMBER

MATERIAL PROCURED UNDER A
☐ DIRECT GOVERNMENT CONTRACT ☐ SUBCONTRACT

1 HAS ANY PART OF THE DOCUMENT CREATED PROBLEMS OR REQUIRED INTERPRETATION IN PROCUREMENT USE?
A GIVE PARAGRAPH NUMBER AND WORDING

B RECOMMENDATIONS FOR CORRECTING THE DEFICIENCIES

2 COMMENTS ON ANY DOCUMENT REQUIREMENT CONSIDERED TOO RIGID

3 IS THE DOCUMENT RESTRICTIVE?
☐ YES ☐ NO *(If "Yes" in what way?)*

4 REMARKS

SUBMITTED BY *(Printed or typed name and address - Optional)*

TELEPHONE NO

DATE

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